other legislators. In Tripura, the BJP won a full majority on its own, with Biplab Kumar Deb taking office as chief minister. In Arunachal, the BJP's first government was formed through defections when thirty-three MLAs of the People's Party of Arunachal joined the BJP in 2016. In 2019, the party won power after winning an election. See PTI, 'BJP forms government in Arunachal Pradesh with PPA MLAs joining it', *The Economic Times*, 31 December 2016, https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/politics-and-nation/bjp-forms-government-in-arunachal-pradesh-with-33-ppa-mlas-joining-it/articleshow/56271718.cms; Sumir Karmakar, 'First BJP govt in Arunachal, CM wins first election', *Deccan Herald*, 23 May 2018, https://www.deccanherald.com/assembly-election-2019/first-bjp-govt-in-arunachal-cm-wins-first-election-735676.html.

14. In Nagaland, Neiphiu Rio of NDPP became chief minister with his eighteen NDPP MLAs, supported by twelve from BJP, one JDU and one NDP MLA. In Meghalaya, Conrad Kongkal Sangma of National People's Party became chief minister in a coalition where the BJP had two seats. The BJP's Yanthungo Patton became deputy chief minister of Nagaland. All political parties in Nagaland, including the BJP, subsequently agreed to form an 'opposition-less' unity government and to re-term the combined alliance as United Democratic Alliance on 18 September 2021. See tweet by Nagaland CM Neiphiu Rio, https://twitter.com/Neiphiu_Rio/status/1439159434748387331?s=20.
15. IANS, 'MNF will never support BJP, says Mizoram minister', *Business Standard*, 6 June 2019, https://www.business-standard.com/article/news-ians/mnf-will-never-support-bjp-says-mizoram-chief-minister-119060600012_1.html; Archis Mohan, 'BJP main opposition party in Sikkim as 10 SDF MLAs join party', *Business Standard*, 14 August 2019, https://www.business-standard.com/article/politics/bjp-now-main-opposition-in-sikkim-as-10-sdf-mla-s-join-party-119081400088_1.html.
16. This was apart from eight seats won by BJP's ally Indigenous People's Front of Tripura (IPFT).